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New York Times (1923-Current file); Aug 6, 1963;

ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The New York Times with Index

pg. 33

BRONX ZOO ADDS NEW ACTS TO BILL

Lion Cubs, Rare Opossum and Baby Raccoon Join Up

By JOHN C. DEVLIN

The Bronx Zoo produced the new, the strange and the exotic yesterday—some of it so new the public can't even see it yet.

The behind-the-scene exhibits include two kitten-sized lion cubs, born only last Thursday, and five rarely seen creatures from Madagascar whose technical name, *Hemicentetes semispinosus*, is almost longer than the creature itself. It is a rodent-like arrival, commonly called a tenrec. It has prickly fur and is here primarily for scientific research on echo location (such as with bats.)

Also, there is what is believed to be probably the world's only known live captive black-shouldered opossum, a creature so rare that the shipper did not know what he was sending and neither did the local zoologist till a scientist at the American Museum of Natural History was finally able to clear up the mystery.

It is on display. The only other specimens known to zoologists here are two skins

on display at the Chicago Natural History Museum, one of whose former members identified the local live animal.

Also on display is a cacomistle, a six-week-old baby member of the raccoon family, which delights the tots (and adults) visiting the animal nursery at the Children's Zoo by nursing from a bottle held by Miss Anne Lamont, 23, a blond attendant who has named her charge Mistletoe.

From time to time Mistletoe brings gales of childish laughter by rolling over on its back and holding the tiny milk bottle with its four paws while it chews lustily on the nipple. It has a ringed tail like a raccoon, scurries happily after

Miss Lamont's feet and is a native to southwestern and western states, and to Mexico. The lion cubs, born to Charlie

and Princess, are barely mobile and are confined in a cage under the lion house at the African Plains area. Princess, a nervous and loving mother, charges at anyone passing her cage.

The cubs spend most of their time napping on a bed of clean straw and probably will not be ready for public display for some months. They will take the place of another pair of lion cubs, born two years ago, that frisked outside when old enough. That pair has gone to another zoo.

The tenrecs—there are five species—cannot be gotten from Madagascar by zoos. They were collected there by Dr. Edwin Gould of Yale University, who has undertaken echo-location research at Johns Hopkins University. The zoo hopes to acquire the tenrecs when he is through with them.